

Sports

Centro Linguistico di Ateneo
Excellence in Linguistic Training



Grammar Focus	Topic Focus
The Passive Voice	Sports in the UK
Conditionals Zero Conditional Type 1 Conditional	Sports Injuries & Accidents Sports Locations
If & Unless	Sporting Equipment
Linking words	

Centro Linguistico di Ateneo
Excellence in Linguistic Training

Sports in the UK

Many famous sports that are now commonly played around the world actually have British roots. Cricket, football, lawn tennis, rugby and golf, to name but a few.

Football

The most popular sport in the UK is **football**. Each country has its own national team, which competes with other teams from around the globe in different world tournaments, such as the well-known FIFA World Cup.
The English Football League has 92 professional clubs, some of which, such as Manchester United, Chelsea, Arsenal and Liverpool, are famous all over the world.
The British take much pride in their countries being represented, and supporters tend to get very excited during the matches. Some of them become quite aggressive due to an excessive intake of beer, and often create problems.
Football is also widely played locally, and though it is very famous in England, it isn't the English national sport!

Cricket

Cricket is England's national sport, though many think it is football. It is played on greens in villages and cities, every Sunday from April to August. The rules of cricket were defined by the Marylebone Cricket Club, based at Lord's cricket ground in north London, in the XVIII century. It is played by two teams of 11 players each, with a ball and a paddle. There are wickets on which bails are balanced and the bowler has to try to throw the ball towards a batter, who must hit it so that the bail doesn't fall off the wicket.

Rugby

Rugby originated from Rugby School, in Warwickshire.
It is similar to American football, but is played with an oval ball and each rugby team is made up of 15 players.
The players must pass the ball to the players behind them, until they reach the goal line.
For many years, rugby was played only by the rich, upper classes, but it has become popular all over the country.
There are two different leagues: the Rugby League, played mainly in the north of England, and the Rugby Union, played in the rest of England, Scotland, Wales and Ireland, together with France and Italy, in a championship called Six Nations Championship or Guinness Six Nations.

Netball

Netball is the most famous female sport in England, and is played almost exclusively by women and girls. Its development, derived from early versions of basketball, began in England in the 1890s. As of 2019, the INF comprises more than 70 national teams organized into five global regions.

Tennis

Tennis is a very popular sport in England, and the world's oldest and most famous tennis tournament is Wimbledon, which originated in a small club in south London in 1877.
The Championship begins on the Monday nearest to June 22nd, a time when English weather is usually perfect. It is traditional for spectators to eat strawberries and cream while watching the matches, and millions of people follow the tournament on television.

Horseracing

As horse breeding has long been part of the British legacy, it is only natural to have horseracing, the sport of Kings, as an important social activity. In fact, it is the second-largest followed sport in Britain, encouraged by the fact that betting on horses, and on anything else you can think of, is a legal and very popular activity in the UK. Horseracing events include the Epsom Derby, the Royal Ascot and the Grand National, one of the most anticipated horseracing events of the year.
The Thoroughbred as it is known today was developed in XVII and XVIII century England, when native mares were crossbred with imported Oriental stallions of Arabian breeding. All modern Thoroughbreds can trace their pedigrees to three stallions originally imported into England in the XVII and XVIII centuries, and to a larger number of foundation mares of mostly English breeding.

Golf

Golf is a very famous sport in Great Britain, but Scotland is traditionally regarded as the home of golf, as it hosts over 400 golf courses. The most famous Scottish golf course is in St. Andrews, a seaside town near Dundee.

Polo
Polo is another equestrian sport, where four horseback mounted players on each team must hit a ball with a mallet (a stick), scoring a goal. Polo was brought to Britain from India by army officers in the XIX century, and is considered the sport of kings. Next to ice hockey, polo is the fastest sport in the world. The horses reach speeds of 30 miles an hour. They must sprint, stop, turn and sprint some more during a seven-minute period (chukker) where the horse might cover three miles. Six chukkers comprise a game. Matches take place on a field that is roughly the size of ten football fields, clipped short to increase the speed. The horses and players often get injured and each player has to have more than one horse, to change it between chukkers, so that it can rest.

Table Tennis
Table tennis (or ping-pong) originated in Victorian England. Some say it was invented in 1880 by Cambridge university students that used cigar boxes to send Champagne corks to the other side of a table, while others suggest that a version of the game was developed by British military officers in India around the 1860s or 1870s, who brought it back with them. A row of books stood up along the centre of the table as a net, two more books served as rackets and were used to continuously hit a golf-ball.

Badminton
Badminton takes its name from the Duke of Beaufort's country manor, Badminton, where this sport, a sort of tennis, was first played in the XIX century, usually as a casual outdoor activity. It is a racquet sport played using racquets to hit a shuttlecock across a net.

Angling
Angling, or fishing, is one of the most popular sports in the UK. An estimate of 3,3 million fishermen regularly participate in this sport, both on rivers and on lakes.

Bowls
Bowls is a variant of the *boules* games (Italian *Bocce*), which, in their general form, are of ancient or prehistoric origin. The objective is to roll balls so that they stop close to a smaller ball called a "jack" or "kitty". It is played on a bowling green, which may be flat (for "flat-green bowls") or convex or uneven (for "crown green bowls"). It is normally played outdoors (although there are many indoor venues) and the outdoor surface is either natural grass or artificial turf.

Rowing
Rowing as a sport is one of the oldest traditions in the world. What began as a method of transport and warfare has become a sport with a wide following, and a part of the cultural identity of the English-speaking world. Rowing in its modern form developed in England in the 1700s. Today rowing is an amateur sport and an Olympic event.

Boxing
In the UK boxing is both amateur and professional, and strict medical regulations are applied in both. This sport probably originated in Ancient Rome, but men lost interest in it when they began carrying weapons and started fencing. As the wearing of swords became less common, there was renewed interest in "fencing" with the fists. The sport reappeared in England during the early XVI century in the form of bare-knuckle boxing, sometimes referred to as prizefighting. Modern boxing is based on the 12 rules defined by the Marquess of Queensberry in 1865.

Darts
Darts is a very popular pub game. The game of darts, as it is known today, was invented in the north of England in a town called Grimsby. However, the origins of the game date back to at least the Middle Ages.

Fencing
Fencing originates in the development of swordsmanship for duels and self defense. The shift towards fencing as a sport rather than as military training happened from the mid-XVIII century, and was led by Domenico Angelo, who established a fencing academy in London in 1763. There, he taught the aristocracy the fashionable art of swordsmanship, establishing the essential rules of posture and footwork that still govern the modern sport of fencing.

Hunting
Unarmed (with no weapons) fox hunting on horseback with hounds, is the type of hunting most closely associated with the United Kingdom; in fact, "hunting" implies fox hunting. Fox hunting is an activity involving the tracking, chase and, if caught, the killing of a fox, traditionally a red fox, by trained foxhounds or other scent hounds, and a group of unarmed followers led by a "master of foxhounds" ("master of hounds"), who follow the hounds on foot or on horseback. Similar to fox hunting in many ways is the chasing of hares with hounds, where the greyhounds are marked as to their skill in coursing (finding) the hare, but are not intended to actually catch it. Other sorts of foxhounds may also be used for hunting stags (deer) or mink. What in other countries is called "hunting" is called "shooting" (birds) or "stalking" (deer) in Britain, and these activities imply the use of rifles.

Running, **cycling**, **basketball** and **swimming** are also very popular sports in the UK.

Sports Injuries

Treatment for a sports injury will depend on factors such as how severe the injury is and the part of your body affected.

Recent research found **football** was the sport most likely to cause injuries, followed by **running**, **rugby**, **cycling** and **swimming**.

Here is a list of a few possible sports injuries:

back pain
broken ankle
bursitis
concussion
hamstring injuries
minor head injuries
shoulder pain
tendonitis
broken arm or wrist
broken leg
cartilage damage
dislocated shoulder
heel pain
severe head injuries
sprains and strains
tennis elbow

Minor injuries, such as mild sprains and strains, can often be initially treated at home using **PRICE therapy** for two or three days.

PRICE stands for **protection**, **rest**, **ice**, **compression** and **elevation**.

Protection – protect the affected area from further injury – for example, by using a support.

Rest – avoid exercise and reduce your daily physical activity. Using crutches or a walking stick may help if you can't put weight on your ankle or knee. A sling may help if you've injured your shoulder.

Ice – apply an ice pack to the affected area for 15-20 minutes every two to three hours. A bag of frozen peas, or similar, will work well. Wrap the ice pack in a towel so that it doesn't directly touch your skin and cause an ice burn.

Compression – use elastic compression bandages during the day to limit swelling.

Elevation – keep the injured body part raised above the level of your heart whenever possible. This may also help reduce swelling.

Painkillers, such as paracetamol, can be used to help ease the pain.

Sports Locations

Football, American Football, Polo, Rugby and Baseball are played on a **field**

Tennis, Volleyball and Basketball are played in a **court**

Hockey and Figure Skating are practiced in an **ice rink** (or simply **rink**)

Golf is played on a **golf course**

Pool and Table Tennis (or Ping-Pong) are played on a **table**

Swimming is done in a **pool**

Races: Car Races, Motorcycle Races, Horse Racing and Running are done on a **track**

Boxing is done in a **ring**

Sporting Equipment

Sporting equipment, also called **sporting goods**, has various forms depending on the sport, but it is essential to complete the sport. It can be used as protective gear or as tool used to help the athletes play the sport. The equipment ranges from balls, to nets, to protective gear like helmets, and can be found in many department stores or specialised stores. The most common equipment is:

Ball - a sports ball is typically round, but can also be oval, as in the case of an American football or a rugby ball.

Net - used in tennis, volleyball, football, hockey and so on. Each net has its own shape and purpose, according to the sport.

Racquet - used for racquet sports, such as tennis, squash and badminton

Stick, bat and club - needed is sports such as polo, cricket, lacrosse, baseball and hockey

Wicket and base - wickets are used in cricket, while bases are used in baseball

Sporting equipment, also includes:

Sports apparel, such as:
Football jerseys, shorts, swimsuits, tanks, sweat suits, t-shirts, windbreakers, ski suits, wetsuits, etc.

Footwear, which include:
Boards for surfing, skateboarding, snowboarding, etc.
Skates for roller skating and ice skating
Skis for skiing and water skiing
Cricket spikes, golf shoes, track spikes, running shoes, walking shoes, etc.

Protective equipment, such as:
Shoulder pads, helmets, mouth guards, boxing gloves, jock straps, shin pads, sports gloves, weight-lifting belts etc.

Vehicles are used as equipment in a number of sports, including motor sport (cars and motorcycles), cycling, aeronautics, sailing and hot air ballooning.

Rifles, longbows, bows and arrows are used in hunting.